

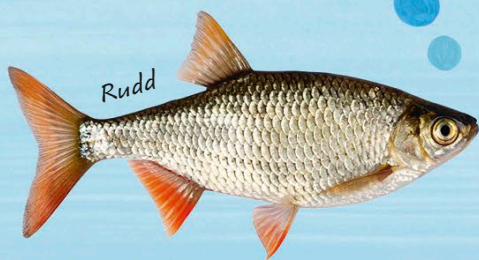


SABIHA KASIMATI

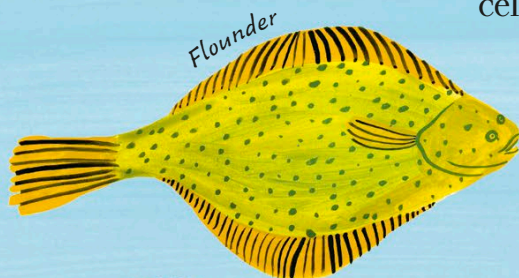
Albanian ichthyologist • 1912–1951



Black sea bream



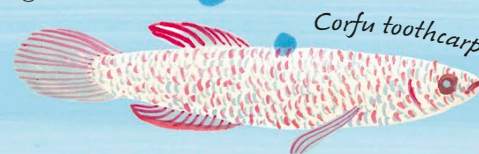
Rudd



Flounder

Scientists don't just spend all day thinking about science! They make a difference in other areas of life, too. Sabiha Kasimati is famous for being Albania's first female scientist and its first ichthyologist (fish scientist). However, she is also celebrated for standing up for reason and science when they were under attack.

Sabiha grew up in Turkey and Albania. She learned to speak many languages and studied biology in Italy. Afterward, she returned to Albania to work at the National Institute of Sciences. For 10 years, Sabiha found out everything she could about the fish living in Albania's ponds, rivers, lakes, and coastal lagoons. But, she had to be careful about everything she did and said—Albania was ruled by Enver Hoxha, a dictator (ruler with total power) who was using force to get his own way. People who upset him were being imprisoned, sent away, or even executed.



Corfu toothcarp



Fishing was important in Albania, but no scientist had really studied the country's fish before. Sabiha visited all kinds of places to collect specimens. She identified them, sorted them into groups, mapped their habitats, and learned about their life cycles.



Adriatic sturgeon



Peacock gudgeon

